know" had become "the public's duty to know." But I told those present that we could not hold anyone responsible but ourselves and that in the interest of sanctifying and nurturing the value of leading by example we, as commanders and senior managers of the organization, had to take the lead in that responsibility.

Meir Amit, who had joined the Mossad in 1964, remodeled the director's office in a style that was functional, simple, and modest. When the Mossad moved to its current location, all of the furniture moved with it.

The Mossad director's desk and the chairs that sat around it served five Mossad chiefs for thirty-two years, until the end of my term. These table and chairs, around which countless decisions had been made, had become something of a symbol over the years, one that many among us did not wish to tinker with. The arrangement in which people sat around the table was also fixed. The deputy director's place was at the narrow edge of the desk, to the right of the director. The others sat opposite him. This seating arrangement was symbolic to a degree, conveying to those present that the director of the Mossad was the one making the decisions. The role of the deputy sitting at his side was only to advise and make recommendations. I take pains to describe the interior of the office in great detail to emphasize the fact that during the many hours I sat at the side of that table over two-and-a-half years, first as a vice-director and later as a deputy, I had a lot of time to think. Following each discussion with the Mossad director I wrote down my reflections in a small notebook. My thought was that the contents of this notebook would become part of my work plan should I one day be appointed director myself.

And indeed, upon entering office, I already had a blueprint for the next half decade, entitled "Effecting Change while Maintaining Continuity." I presented it during my first few days on the job, to the prime minister, to the Knesset Foreign Affairs and Defense Committee's Subcommittee on Intelligence and Secret Services, and to the Rasha Forum. For reasons that are clear, I cannot divulge the plan here, aside from some morsels that I believe do not constitute a violation of secrecy today.

At the end of the first quarter of 1989, I was aware that the next five years would bear witness to far-reaching changes, the beginnings of which could already be discerned. I judged that Iraq would become the most threatening force in the Middle East and would approach nuclear capability. I assessed that nonconventional warfare, including cyberwarfare and nuclear,